

Chapter 90-3

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The gathering went on until past eleven, and basically everyone was resting at the hotel. The hotel rooms the director had booked were assigned according to the actors' status—Zhao Ying and Shu Yi's rooms were nicer, while Liang Shi's was just an ordinary room with a queen bed, a private bathroom and a balcony. It was decent enough.

Yan Xi was staying right next door to her.

What surprised Liang Shi was that this little princess Yan Xi didn't throw a fuss about going home. Instead, she stayed at the hotel with everyone else, and she had even sent her wet nurse home, leaving only herself.

Yan Xi had drunk some alcohol, but not much.

When going back, she stood at the door and waved at Liang Shi like a bunny: "Go to bed early, and remember to say goodnight to my gorgeous beauty for me. I love her!"

Liang Shi: "..."

Young people's world nowadays was very straightforward. Liang Shi found it a bit hard to understand.

But Yan Xi's words still made Liang Shi feel a bit uncomfortable.

My gorgeous beauty...

My...

What was that about.

She was clearly... forget it, she belonged to everyone.

After Liang Shi returned to her hotel room, she drank several gulps of water before suppressing that sour feeling in her heart. Then she opened the balcony door to let in some air. When she stood on the balcony looking down at the view outside, she noticed a head poking out from the balcony next door. Yan Xi waved at her again: "Make sure you remember to say goodnight to my gorgeous beauty! That's what I want to say!"

Liang Shi glanced at her: "It's not like you don't have her on WeChat."

Yan Xi fake-cried: "Wuwuwu, I want to be a quiet and well-behaved junior, I can't disturb her."

Liang Shi: "..."

Aish.

She really wanted to hit something.

In the end, Liang Shi closed the balcony door and made a video call to Xu Qingzhu.

She had drunk a bit of alcohol tonight—not to the point of being drunk, but her face was flushed. Her brown long hair was tucked neatly behind her ears, pressed against the headboard. Her back was also leaning against the headboard. Under the light, she looked drowsy, but she still held up her phone to look.

It took a long time for Xu Qingzhu to answer on the other end—so long it was almost about to automatically disconnect.

Liang Shi thought she wasn't going to pick up.

After Xu Qingzhu answered, she fiddled with the camera before switching to the front-facing one. Before she adjusted it, the camera captured the living room—empty and looking devoid of any signs of life. After she adjusted it, the camera showed Xu Qingzhu. She was wearing a pink bunny headband, her skin fair and delicate. The hair by her ears was damp, and there was still a drop of water on the tip of her nose.

Even with the infamous close-up camera angle, it didn't reveal any flaws on her face. Instead, she looked even more pure and innocent.

Her freshly washed face was white with a rosy tint. Her somewhat glamorous features carried a touch of innocence because of the pink bunny headband on her head—her aura was perfectly balanced.

Liang Shi's heart skipped a beat. She instinctively reached out to wipe away that drop of water on her nose.

But she only touched the cold screen.

Suddenly, it was like waking from a dream.

She had grown accustomed to sharing a space with another person. Even if she wasn't living with Xu Qingzhu, she knew that just by pushing open the door, Xu Qingzhu lived right across from her—they were in the same space.

But now, suddenly staying at a hotel, even though the person next door was someone she knew, she still didn't feel a sense of belonging.

Liang Shi smiled, with a hint of bitterness mixed in. The room had only the dim yellow bedside lamp on, casting a dreamy glow over her entire being.

Xu Qingzhu asked: "What are you smiling about? Did you drink?"

Liang Shi nodded: "A little bit."

"Teacher Liang is impressive." Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue. "Your alcohol tolerance has been improving lately—drinking every day, drinking every night. Without you, the distillery would go bankrupt."

Liang Shi: "?"

Suddenly there were thorns.

Liang Shi still smiled gently: "What's wrong? Did I make you angry again?"

"How could that be?" Xu Qingzhu's tone was flat, her cool voice lilting upward. "Teacher Liang just had a bit to drink. Why would I be angry?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She continued looking at the screen with a faint smile. In her slightly tipsy state, those eyes gazed at Xu Qingzhu through the screen full of tender affection, looking gentle and indulgent.

Her voice after drinking carried a slight hoarseness. She slowed down and called her name: "Xu Qingzhu."

Xu Qingzhu was momentarily stunned, pausing before responding: "Hm?"

Liang Shi's husky voice was lazy and casual: "Talk properly."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

After a moment, Xu Qingzhu asked helplessly: "How much did you drink?"

"Really not much." Liang Shi shook her head helplessly. "I didn't expect this body to be so bad at drinking. I used to have a really good tolerance."

Xu Qingzhu was speechless: "So where are you now?"

"At a hotel." Liang Shi said: "The director arranged it for everyone. I originally wanted to go home, but the director said it would be best not to, so I didn't."

"Who's at the hotel with you?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi panned her phone around the room: "Just me. Who else could there be?"

Xu Qingzhu: "...Who knows?"

"Teacher Xu." Liang Shi called her name gently with a smile, the corners of her lips curved upward. Those light brown pupils looked infinitely affectionate, but her words carried a hint of provocation: "If you don't believe me, come check for yourself."

"You think I wouldn't dare?" Xu Qingzhu sat on the dark-colored sofa at home, leaning her head back, and suddenly asked: "Tonight you almost embraced a beautiful woman. Who was that?"

Liang Shi suddenly frowned: "Who? I didn't embrace anyone."

Xu Qingzhu sent her the photo. When questioning, her cool voice sounded thin and cold: "And you call this not embracing?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Oh, that." After seeing Quella, Liang Shi's composure crumbled a bit—it was that kind of regret of realizing a genius had been right beside her but she had missed the opportunity. She sighed.

Then Xu Qingzhu said: "What? Regretting that you didn't pick up the girl?"

"No." Liang Shi explained: "She's a director. She drank too much and almost fell, so I reached out to steady her. I couldn't just let her fall into my arms, could I?"

"Why not?" Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow slightly. "She would have just fallen into your arms. Let nature take its course."

Liang Shi: "..."

Was that how "let nature take its course" was supposed to be used?

But...

Liang Shi suddenly asked lightly: "Teacher Xu, are you jealous?"

"How could I be?" Xu Qingzhu propped her arm on the sofa, resting her head on her hand. Her posture sitting on the sofa was lazy and comfortable. She said casually: "A colleague sent me this picture. Teacher Liang, next time you sneak a bite, wipe your mouth clean. Don't let people see."

Liang Shi: "...!!"

"I didn't..." Liang Shi immediately explained: "She's really a director. If you don't believe me, look her up. I just happened to meet her once before, and this time I ran into her again and we just exchanged a few words. There's nothing between us at all—we haven't even added each other on WeChat."

By the end, Liang Shi sounded quite dejected.

"Sounds like you're quite regretful?" Xu Qingzhu asked back.

Liang Shi paused. Her drunk brain hadn't caught up yet, and she nodded: "Mm, very regretful."

After she said that, Xu Qingzhu's expression changed. Liang Shi immediately tried to make up for it: "It's not that kind of regret, it's..."

Before she could finish speaking, Liang Shi suddenly froze.

Because a new notification had popped up at the top of her screen—it was an email.

Her work email had received an email from Gu Yixue. The content was very brief: [Hello, Liang Shi, do you remember me? My WeChat is: ... I have a role here that I'd like you to try out for. If you're willing, add me. Of course, even if you're not willing, you can still add me. I forgot to ask for your contact info tonight, so I used your work email to find you. Gu Yixue.]